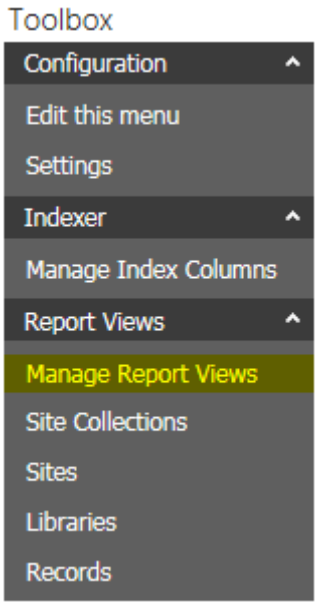
Managing report views

The *Manage Report Views* link on the home page of the **Smart Records** site takes you to a list of all available views grouped by view type. You can use this list to create, edit and delete views from the site.



The Start View

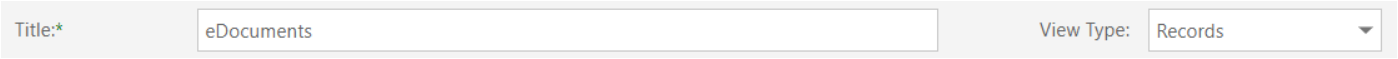
The default view shown when viewing Records Reports is titled the 'Start' view. This view contains prompt fields, which users can use to query across all records, but can be edited according to specific customer needs or preferences. For example, a customer may wish to view all records by default, grouped by Function and Activity, with specific display fields which allow filtering across their whole environment.

Edit or create new View

When you edit or create a new view, a window is displayed allowing you to configure the following view settings. Once created the view is shown in the Manage Report Views list and the dropdown menu above any open report. The view is not automatically added to the home page navigation so if you want it to appear there you need to update the menu, see Changing the Menu for more information.

View Settings

Title and View Type



The *View Title* is the display name for your view and is a required value. You can use any name you like but should ensure that it:

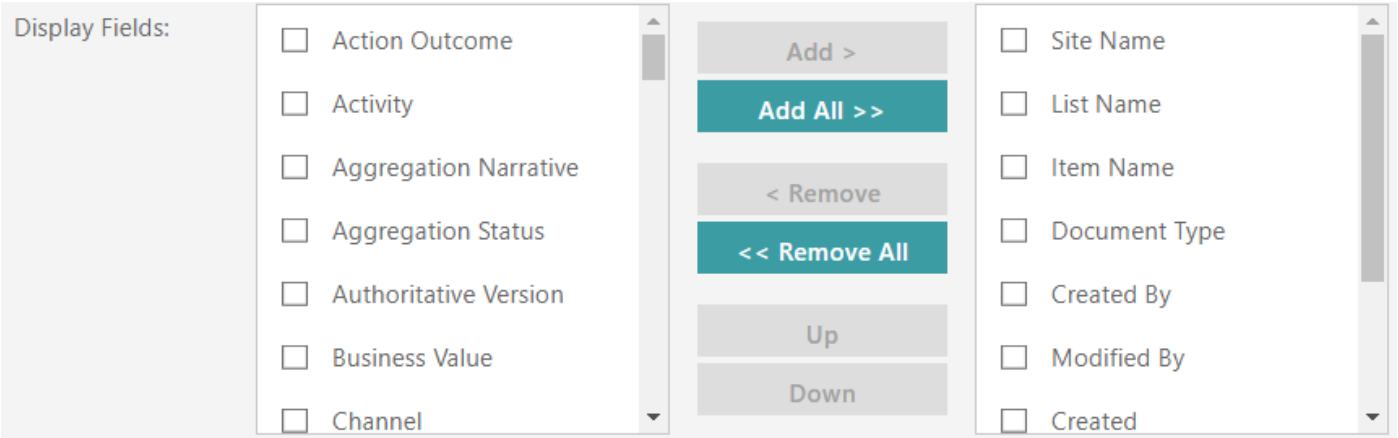
- It is unique, reports can have duplicate names but obviously this makes it difficult
- Clearly explains to other users what the report is for
- Contains no special characters (e.g. &,%,$ etc.)

There are two *View Types* available - Records (the default) and Libraries. These control the fields available for display, sort etc. based on the information in the Index column settings.

Normally this is only set when a report is first created; if you do alter this setting then you need to make sure any columns already selected are valid for the new type.

Library View Type: You will notice that if you select Libraries, the fields offered do not change initially. Just name the report and select "Update" then select the edit icon next to the report and the correct fields will be there.

Display Fields



The left-hand panel displays all the columns available based on the View Type, the right-hand panel displays the currently selected columns.

You can use the buttons in the middle to add or remove current items and to change the display order. You must have at least one display column selected.

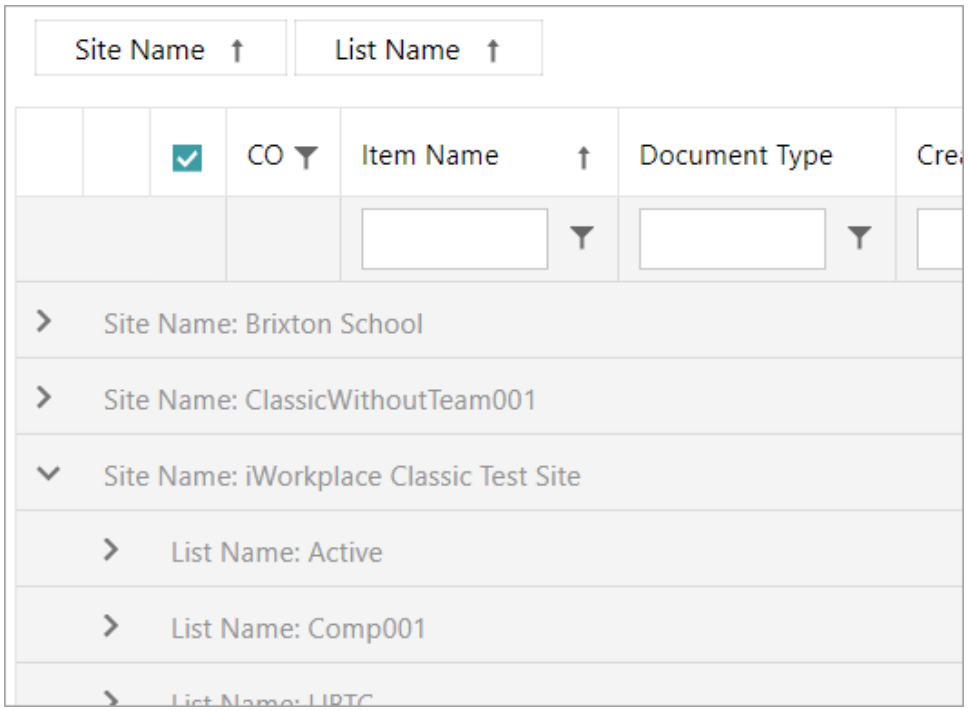
Sort Fields

You can add or remove sort columns in the same way as the display ones. You can also change the order the columns, its important to make sure the columns are sorted in the right sequence as otherwise the results can appear haphazard to users.

By default, the sort order is ascending (e.g. A to Z), the Descending tick box reverses this (Z to A). This affects all selected sort columns. Its not possible to change the sort order for just one column.

Group Fields

These work in the same way as the sort columns but obviously control how things are grouped in the report. The grouping is always applied before the sorting when the report is rendered so there is no need to sort on the group columns.



By default, the groups are initially displayed collapsed so only a summary line is displayed, however this behaviour can be changed by ticking the **Expand Groups** option.

Prompt Fields

Most reports do not use Prompts because they will have pre-defined filters and the user can use the on-the-fly filtering to reduce the information further.

However, prompts do have the advantage that nothing is shown until at least one prompt value has been entered. Because of this, the initial display of the report is quick, and the time taken to return the results is normally quicker as well as it only has the information required.

Prompt reports can still be filtered down further using on-the-fly filtering just like normal views and any filters built into the report are still applied on top of the prompt values.

The arrow at the top of the filters allows them to be hidden after the user has done their search to give more screen space to the results.

If you edit a report and delete all existing prompt values, then you may see a blank report when you click ok. Just navigate back to the report and it will be displayed correctly.

Filters

Filtering in views works in the same way as filters in rules. You can define up to ten filters for a single view.

When you have two or more filters you can join them together using either ANDs or ORs. The filters are processed from top to bottom in pairs, so it is important to order your filters correctly if you are using both ANDs and ORs.

You can filter for blank values by leaving the value detail blank.

Smart Records removes all apostrophes and other special characters from text as it stores metadata, filenames etc. in the index. Therefore, filter values should not include special characters, including commas, apostrophes and "&". For example, "How to's and fixes" is not valid, nor is "How tos & fixes". However, "How tos and fixes" (no apostrophe or ampersand) is a valid value.

Filters are defined in three parts:

- *Column name* - The name of the column to check in the library. This is case sensitive. The current version will provide prompts for columns; however, you can edit this e.g. Item name can be changed to name.
- *Condition* - The usual condition options equals, not equals, greater than etc.
- *Value* - The value to check for, is no longer case sensitive (since May 2017). For dates it is possible to use [Today] to automatically insert today's date. You can follow [Today] with a minus sign and a number to remove that number of days from the date e.g. [Today]-365 would be a year ago today. If you want to use a particular date, then it should be entered in the YYYY-MM-DD format.

For more information on filters including examples check out the *Rules filters* section.

Performance Boost

This option adds a custom index in the database to match the parameters of the report that should improve the performance of the report.

Each index created does have an impact on the performance of the index process, the more indexes the slower the index process will be.

Even if a report does not have this box ticked then it may benefit from an index setup for another report if the reports are similar, if so, then ticking this box will not boost the performance further. For example, with the four standard Records Created views, you would only need to index one of these to improve the performance on all of them, indexing a second would have little or no impact.